FAT LOSS · EATING OUT

Eating out on a fat loss plan

Restaurants, family dinners and weekend plans, without undoing your week.

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Vimal

Head coach, Train With Vimal

1 · EATING OUT IS FINE

One meal does not undo a week

Fat loss comes from what you do most days. A dinner out is one meal out of about 28 in a week. Plan it, enjoy it, log it, and go back to your plan at the next meal.

1

Look at the menu before you go and pick your order at home.

2

Eat a normal, protein-rich lunch. Don't arrive starving.

3

Log the meal the same night. A rough log beats no log.

2 · RULES OF THUMB

Six rules that work in any restaurant

You don't need to know the calories of every dish. These six habits get you most of the way.

1

Start with protein

Order a tikka, a grilled fish, an egg dish or a dal first. Protein fills you up, so you eat less of everything else.

2

Grilled over fried

Tandoori, grilled, roasted and steamed are your friends. Fried, crispy and "golden" add 150–300 kcal a plate.

3

Sauces and dressings on the side

Ask for them on the side and use a spoon, not the whole bowl. Butter and cream sauces are where calories hide.

4

One carb, not three

Pick rice *or* roti *or* naan. Two rotis or one small bowl of rice is plenty with a protein and a vegetable.

5

Half a plate of vegetables

Salad, raita, a dry sabzi or a clear soup. They make the plate big without making it heavy.

6

Stop at comfortably full

Put the spoon down for two minutes halfway through. If you are still hungry after that, eat more vegetables.

3 · READING AN INDIAN MENU

The words on the menu tell you a lot

Most Indian menus use the same words for how a dish is cooked. Learn these and you can order anywhere.

Pick often	Sometimes	Rarely
Tandoori	Jeera rice	Makhani
Tikka	Butter naan	Malai
Grilled / roasted	Paneer bhurji	Shahi, korma
Dal tadka	Kadai dishes	Butter masala
Chana masala	Biryani (half)	Pakora, kofta
Raita, salad	Dosa, uttapam	“Crispy” anything
Clear soup	Chole bhature (share)	Extra ghee on top

Ask for: “less oil”, “no butter on top” and “gravy on the side”. Most kitchens are happy to do it, and it saves 100–200 kcal without changing the dish.

4 · 12 ORDERS THAT FIT YOUR PLAN

Order one of these and relax

Numbers are for one person and are close enough for your log.

ORDER	KCAL	PROTEIN
Paneer tikka (6 pcs) + 1 roti + salad	520	30 g
Dal tadka + 1 roti + raita	480	22 g
Tandoori chicken (half) + salad Skip the butter on top	450	48 g
Grilled fish + sautéed vegetables	420	40 g
Chana masala + small jeera rice	560	18 g
Chicken tikka + mint chutney + 1 roti	480	42 g
2 egg masala omelette + 2 toast	430	24 g
Masala dosa + sambar Ask for less oil, skip the extra chutney	500	12 g
Chicken biryani (half plate) + raita	600	32 g
Rajma + small rice + salad	540	20 g
Grilled chicken burrito bowl, no sour cream	580	40 g
Thin-crust veg pizza (3 slices) + salad	620	24 g

5 · DRINKS AND DESSERTS

Where the hidden calories are

Drinks and desserts can add more than the meal itself. You don't have to skip them, just pick smart.

DRINK	KCAL	BETTER SWAP
Sweet lassi (glass)	**260**	Chaas, 40 kcal
Cola (can)	**140**	Diet cola or soda, 0 kcal
Fresh lime soda, sweet	**120**	Fresh lime soda, salted, 10 kcal
Mango shake	**320**	Whole mango slices, 100 kcal
Beer (pint)	**210**	One drink, then water

Share

One dessert for the table. Three spoons give you the taste.

Pick

Rasgulla or kulfi over gulab jamun or brownie with ice cream.

Water

One glass before the meal and one with it. You'll order less.

6 · BACK TO PLAN

The next meal is a normal meal

No skipping breakfast, no extra cardio to “burn it off”. Just go back to your plan.

After a meal out

- [ ] Log the meal in the app the same night. Pick the closest dish and an honest portion.
- [ ] Drink 2–3 glasses of water before bed. Salty food holds water, so the scale may jump.
- [ ] Ignore the scale for 2 days. A jump after a dinner out is water, not fat.
- [ ] Eat your normal planned breakfast the next morning.
- [ ] Do your next workout as planned. No punishment sessions.

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From Vimal: the clients who do best are not the ones who never eat out. They are the ones who eat out, enjoy it and come straight back to the plan. If a dinner out is coming up, tell your coach in your check-in and we’ll plan around it.